We need to know three things: first, what soft power resources or capabilities does a country possess (in foreign policy, culture, and politics); are foreigners attracted, repulsed, or neutral towards the foreign policy, culture, or political values of another country; and do those perceptions affect their actual behaviour? In the end, this three-step logic would require getting inside the heads of large numbers of people (and particularly government officials) and then tracking their actions towards the country in question – an almost impossible task. The focus in this section therefore is largely on the first element: what kind of soft power resources or capabilities do India and China possess? Even this is a challenging task since the data is scattered and incomplete. Fortunately, the Lowy Institute in Australia, in its comprehensive measure of Asian power, has produced various measures of soft power which correspond roughly to foreign policy influence, cultural influence, and political influence.[32]

How, then, do India and China compare on foreign policy influence? According to the Lowy Institute's measure of 'diplomatic influence', which is an aggregate of several other measures, India ranks sixth and China ranks first among twenty-five Asian powers which include the US (Lowy includes the US as an Asian power given its massive military, diplomatic, economic, and cultural interests and presence in the continent). A closer look at the Lowy measure shows that it distinguishes between two elements of diplomatic influence: diplomatic networks; and perceived foreign policy leadership, ambition, and effectiveness. Broadly, India does well on the networks component, often nearly matching China; but, crucially for the purposes of estimating soft power, it does much less well on perceptions of its willingness and ability to lead other countries in international affairs.[33]

What about cultural influence? Lowy's overall measure of 'cultural influence' ranks India in fourth place and China in second place in Asia (with the US in first place by a considerable distance). Lowy divides cultural influence into three elements: cultural projection; information flows; and people exchanges (including in- and out-migration).In cultural projection, India scores better on Google searches abroad of its newspapers and its television/radio broadcasts, and it exports more of its 'cultural